cleaning and chopping leeks



1 With a large knife, trim off the root and some of the dark green leaf at the top, then slice the leek lengthwise in two and fan it open.



2 Rinse the leek under cold running water to remove the soil that tends to collect between the layers, then pat it dry with paper towels.



3 Sit the halved leek on the cutting board and slice it into thick or thin strips, according to the recipe.

chopping carrots



Peel the carrot, then slice it lengthwise. Cut the lengths crosswise, then stack them and cut into batons. Slice across the batons to make even-sized dice.

sweating vegetables



Sweating chopped vegetables in oil or butter gives a soup a more pronounced flavor. Heat a little fat over low heat, stir in the vegetables, then add a pinch of salt, cover, and cook for 5–10 minutes or until soft but not brown.